

How Atul Limited Saved Millions with FOSS!

In an endeavour to cut down on rising costs and to slash initial investments, Atul Limited, a chemical conglomerate, sought refuge in FOSS. The outcome? The company saved a whopping Rs 85 million within a short span of time.



The open source team at Atul Limited

Bringing down IT costs and managing to save a colossal amount of money in a depressed economy is no mean feat! Atul Limited, part of the Rs 90 billion Lalbhai Group, has set an example of sorts as it charted a new growth story with the help of open source technology. Not many know that the Gujarat-based company that has ventured into segments like aromatics, bulk chemicals, crop protection, polymers, etc, is India's first private sector firm to be inaugurated by Jawaharlal Nehru in 1952. With a customer base of 4,000, the enterprise has kept up its winning streak by optimising its IT costs through the use of FOSS. We got in touch with Balaranjith T, general manager, IT, Atul Limited, to retrace the open source journey of the company.

Tryst with FOSS

Primarily a user of Oracle and Microsoft technologies, the firm came across bottlenecks like vendor lock-in and the rising cost of IT, including software licences. But being an IT-savvy company that was directed by the management to automate each and every manual process, the firm decided to go the open source way. "We also found that leading technology companies like Facebook, Yahoo and Google use open source solutions for their business critical applications. This gave us the confidence to adopt open source in a big way. Our FOSS journey began in 2009 when we migrated our Oracle E-Business Suite server from the AIX platform to a Linux platform. Then, in 2011, we started using Ubuntu as the primary desktop OS. This helped us to